EDGE IN / VERDICT OUT

Edge Lab

User manual

How to use every screen: what to click, what to type, and how to read what comes back. The app itself shows only the numbers. The explanations are in this manual.

Version 2.18.0 · Windows and macOS · produced by jiidc · MIT licensed
Offline: no account, no telemetry, no network. Your journal stays on your machine.
Open this manual any time from the ? button at the top right of the app.

Contents

Part 1 — Getting started

1. What Edge Lab does
2. The one unit: R
3. The screen at a glance
4. Quick start

Part 2 — Journal

5. Accounts
6. Logging a trade
7. The trade log
8. Filters
9. Equity and dollars
10. Rule guard
11. Stats — Performance
12. Stats — Edge report
13. Stats — Timing
14. Stats — Calendar
15. Backups and your data

Part 3 — Simulator

16. Your edge: sliders or journal
17. Leave out (what if I stop…)
18. Your account, and prop firm mode
19. Validate
20. Challenge
21. Funded (optimizer)
22. Decision

Part 4 — Reference

23. Messages you may see
24. What the model assumes
25. Glossary
26. Keyboard shortcuts
27. Troubleshooting

Part 1 — Getting started

1. What Edge Lab does

Edge Lab answers two questions every trader has to get right, for any strategy and any market:

- **Is my edge real?** Or is my record still explainable by luck?
- **How much should I risk?** What drawdown should I plan for, and what size survives it?

If you trade a funded account, **prop firm mode** adds a third: what size passes this firm's evaluation, keeps the funded account alive, and pays you? It is off until you turn it on (section 18).

It has two modes, switched with the buttons at the top right:

MODE	USE IT TO
`Journal`	Log your trades, review them, and see what your record says: stats, strengths and leaks, timing and calendar. In prop firm mode, also how close each account is to its firm's rules.
`Simulator`	Run your edge thousands of times: whether it is real, and the drawdown to plan for. In prop firm mode, also your odds of passing, your payouts once funded, and whether the challenge is worth buying.

The two modes connect through one switch, **`Use my journal`**. When it is on, the Simulator runs on your logged trades instead of the sliders.

2. The one unit: R

1R is the amount you planned to lose on a trade, the distance from entry to stop times your size. A trade that makes twice what you risked is **+2R**. A full stop-out is **−1R**. A trade closed at break-even is a **scratch** (0R).

Edge Lab works in R because R does not depend on account size. Your edge is the same whether you trade a $25,000 or a $150,000 account. Dollars come in at the end: set what 1R is worth (Journal) or your risk per trade (Simulator), and the app converts.

> WHY IT MATTERS
>
> A trade with no stop, no Risk $ and no R override has no R. It still counts toward win rate and dollar totals, but every R statistic leaves it out. Log a stop or a Risk $ on every trade.

3. The screen at a glance

On start, a notice says Edge Lab is free: if you paid for it, you were scammed. The only official download is github.com/jiifx/edge-lab. Tick **`Do not show this again`** before **`Got it`** (or `Esc`) to stop it appearing.



The header: brand, mode switch, manual, reload, colour scheme.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
`Simulator / Journal`	Switches mode. Each mode keeps its own state.
`?`	Opens this manual.

↻ (reload)	Reloads the app (F5). If a trade editor is open, it asks first.
◐ (colour scheme)	Picks a colour scheme: System (follows your OS), Daylight, Forest, Carbon, Midnight or Parchment.
Check for updates	At the bottom of the Simulator, beside the version number. Opens the releases page in your browser. The app never goes online by itself.

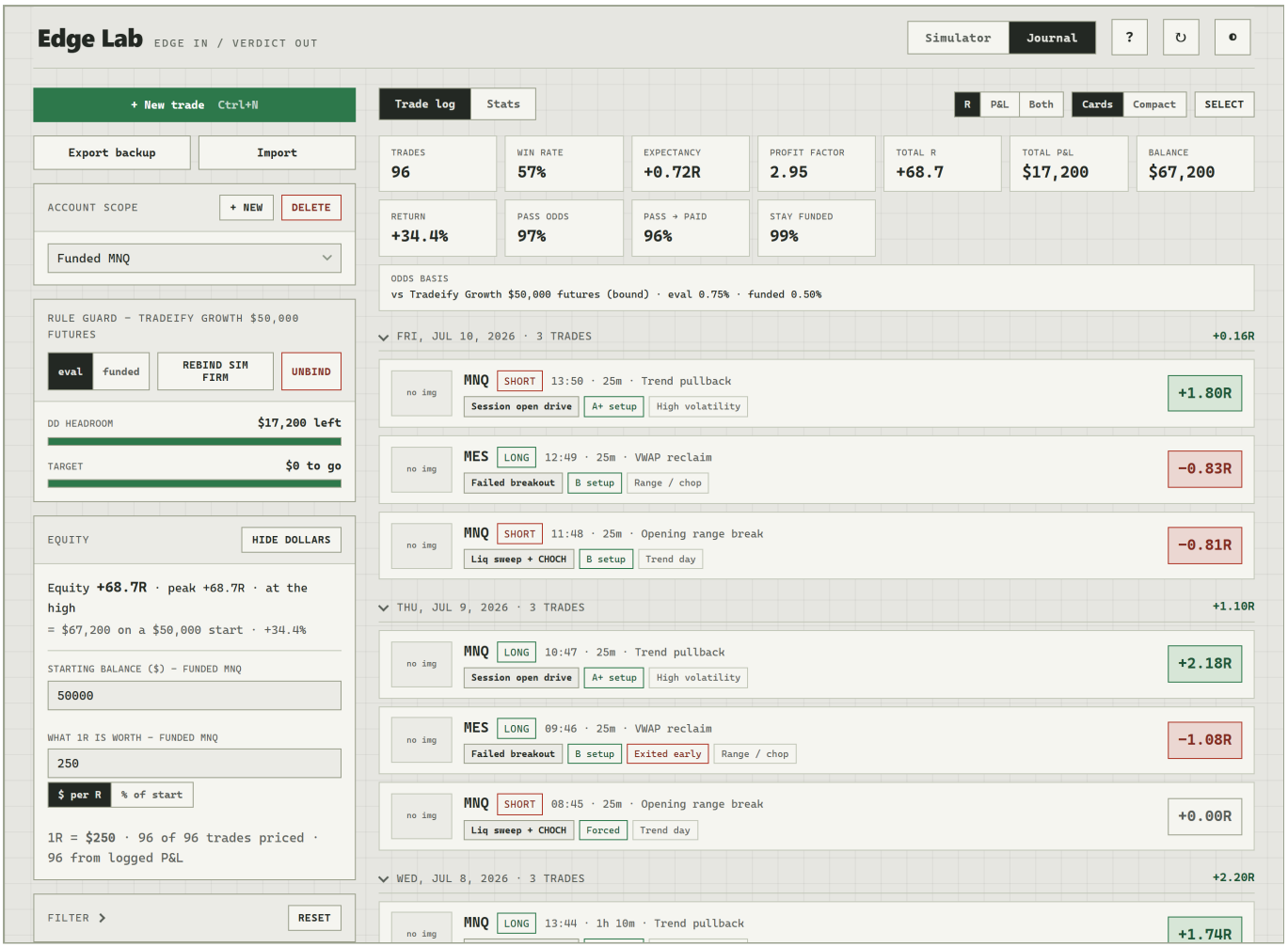
Both modes share a layout: a **rail** of controls on the left and the **results** on the right. Change something on the left and the right side recalculates.

4. Quick start

Just looking? Open **Journal** and, on the empty journal, click **Load sample journal**: 1,000 made-up futures trades with a modest real edge, on an account called **Sample 50k**. Everything below works on it. Delete that account when you are done.

1. **Create an account.** In **Journal**, click **+ New** in Account scope. Name it after the trading account, e.g. "Futures 50k".
2. **Log your trades.** Click **+ New trade** (Ctrl+N). At minimum: instrument, session, and a result (prices, or Risk $ plus P&L, or an R value).
3. **Set your account.** Switch to **Simulator**, click **Edit** in Your account and enter its size and the most you can afford to lose (max drawdown).
4. **Turn on Use my journal.** It needs at least 10 resolved trades. The Simulator now runs on your record.
5. **Read Validate:** is the edge real, what drawdown to plan for, and the largest risk per trade that fits your limit.
6. **Trading a prop firm?** Tick **Prop firm** in the same panel, set the firm's rules, then read Challenge → Funded → Decision. In Journal, pick the account and click **Bind sim firm** in Rule guard. The rule meters now track that account live.

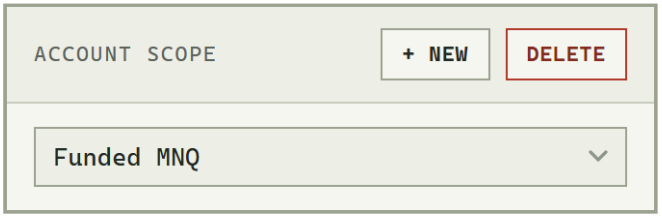
Part 2 — Journal



The Journal: rail on the left, trade log on the right.

5. Accounts

Every trade belongs to one account. Keep **one journal account per prop account**. The rule guard and prop odds treat an account's trades as the real history of that account.

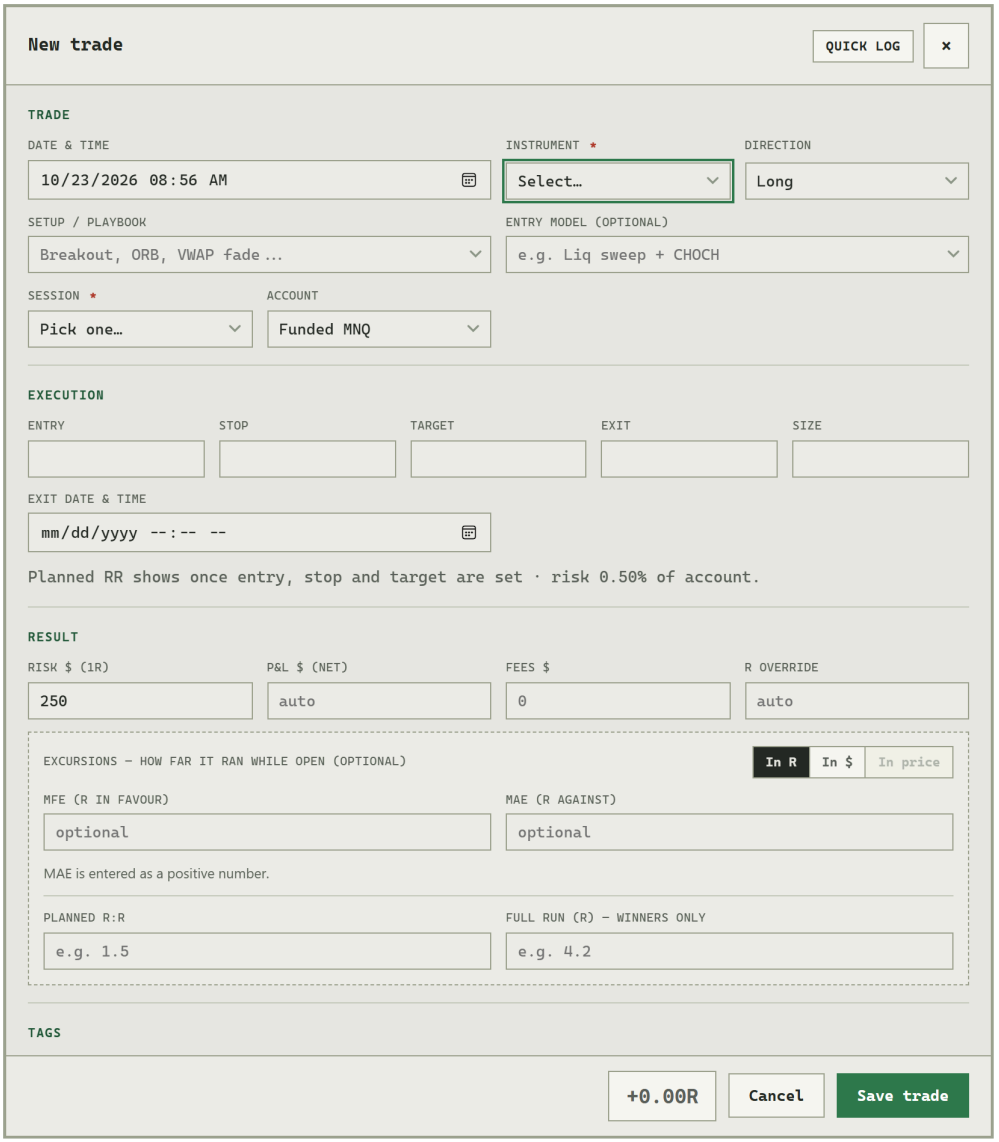


Account scope.

- **Create:** `+ New`, type a name, confirm.
- **Switch:** pick it in the Account scope dropdown. The log, stats, filters, equity and odds all follow the scope.
- **All accounts:** combines everything. Useful for overall stats. Rule guard needs a single account.
- **Delete:** select the account, click `Delete`, confirm. Its trades go at once; click `Undo` in the message that appears to bring the account back. When the message closes, its trades and screenshots are gone for good (unless you have a backup).

6. Logging a trade

Click `+ New trade` or press `Ctrl+N`. Save with `Save trade` or `Ctrl+Enter`. `Quick log` hides the deeper sections for fast capture. Switch back to the full form any time.



The trade editor (full form).

Trade

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
`Date & time`	When you entered. Used by Calendar, Timing and the rule guard's daily limits.
`Instrument *`	Required. Pick from the list or choose custom and type it.
`Direction`	Long or short.
`Setup / playbook`	Your name for the setup. Earlier ones are suggested as you type.
`Entry model`	Optional. The trigger you used (e.g. "Liq sweep + CHOCH"). Gets its own table in the Edge report and its own filter.
`Session *`	Required: Asia, London, New York or Other. It is a tag you pick, not read off the clock, so it stays right in any timezone.
`Account`	Which account the trade belongs to.

Execution

`Entry, Stop, Target, Exit, Size`	Prices and size. With entry and stop the app knows 1R. With a target too it shows the planned R:R. With an exit it computes the result.
`Exit date & time`	Optional. Enables holding time and the after-a-loss table on the Timing tab.

Result

`Risk $ (1R)`	What one full loss would cost. Defaults to the account's R value if one is set.
`P&L $ (net)`	Leave on *auto* and it fills itself as **R × Risk $ − fees**. Type your own figure to override. Clear it to go back to auto.
`Fees $`	Commissions for the trade.
`R override`	Type the R result directly if you journal without prices. Otherwise R = P&L ÷ Risk $.
`MFE / MAE`	Optional. How far the trade ran in your favour (MFE) and against you (MAE) while open. Enter in R, $ or price with the switch. **MAE is entered as a positive number**: 0.6 means it sat 0.6R offside. $ mode needs a Risk $; price mode needs entry and stop.
`Planned R:R`	The target you set, in R. Type it here if you log without prices. It is derived automatically when entry, stop and target are filled.
`Full run (R) — winners only`	How far price got **before it would have come back to your stop**, whether or not you were still in. Losers need nothing: losing already proves the run fell short. This feeds the target sweep (section 11).

> COMMON MIX-UP
>
> Planned R:R is where your order sat, not how far price went. Putting the MFE in the Planned R:R box makes the target sweep report that your winners fell short of their own targets.

Tags, psychology, review, screenshots

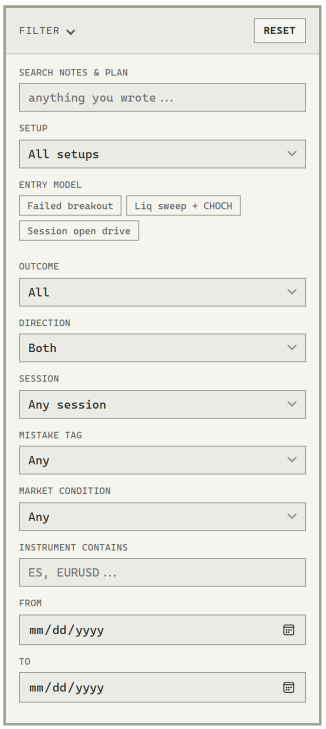
- **Quality** (pick one): A+ setup, B setup, C setup, Forced, Revenge trade.
- **Mistakes** (any): Entered early/late, Sized too large, No stop, Moved stop, Exited early, Held too long, Outside plan, Chased, Overtraded.
- **Market conditions** (any): Trend day, Range / chop, High volatility, Low volume, News day, Open drive, Reversal.
- **Emotion before / after** (1 calm – 5 tilted) and **Followed the plan?** These feed the Edge report and the day guard.
- **Plan / thesis** and **Notes / review**: free text, searchable from the filter.
- **Screenshots:** click the drop zone, drag images in, or paste with `Ctrl+V` / **`Paste from clipboard`**.

7. The trade log

- The strip above the log shows the scope's headline numbers: trades, win rate, expectancy, profit factor, totals, balance and, when a firm applies, the prop odds.
- Trades are grouped by day with a daily total. **Click a day header to fold or unfold it.** On a long journal only the 15 most recent days start open.
- **`Cards`** / **`Compact`**: cards show the screenshot and tags; compact shows one line per trade.
- Click a trade to open its detail view.

- **Detail view:** ← / → steps through trades. `Edit` opens the editor. Click a screenshot to zoom: scroll to zoom, drag to pan, double-click to fit.
- **Unit switch** (top right): show results in `R`, `P&L` or `Both`. P&L needs dollars turned on (section 9).
- **Bulk delete:** `Select`, tick trades or use `All`, then `Delete (n)`. `All` picks only the trades shown, not those inside folded days.
- **Undo:** after any delete, an `Undo` button shows for a few seconds and brings the trades back with their screenshots.

8. Filters

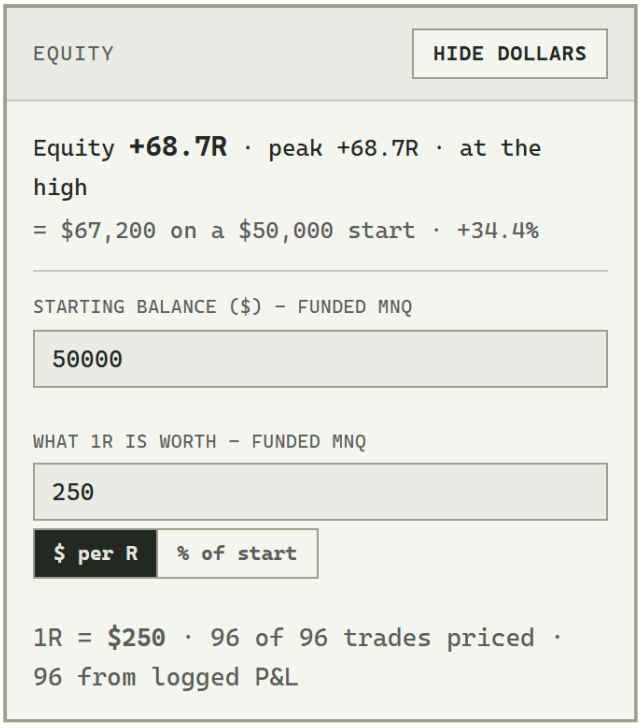


The Filter panel.

The Filter panel is folded by default: click `Filter` to open it. When filters are on, the header shows how many (e.g. **2 on**). Filters narrow the log **and every Stats tab**. Combine any of: text search (notes and plan), setup, entry model, outcome, direction, session, mistake tag, market condition, instrument, date range. `Reset` clears them all.

Clicking a row in the Edge report adds a **segment filter** chip above the log. Click its × to remove it.

9. Equity and dollars



The Equity panel with dollars shown.

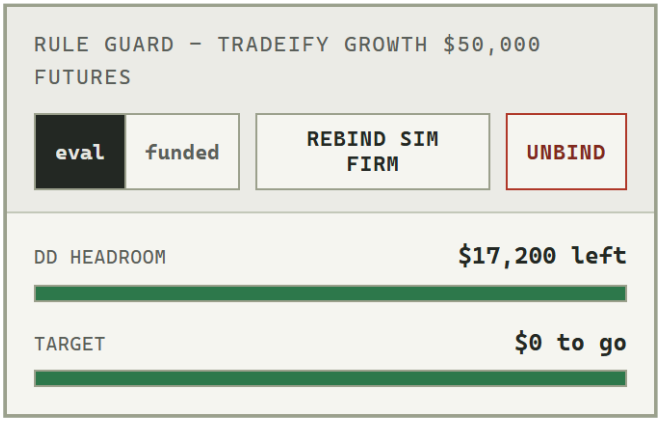
The journal works in R by default. To see money:

1. Pick a single account in Account scope.
2. Click `Show dollars` in the Equity panel.
3. Enter a **Starting balance**.
4. Enter **What 1R is worth**, either `$ per R` (fixed dollars) or `% of start`.

Trades logged in R only are then priced at that value. Trades with a logged P&L keep their own figure. The line under the inputs says how many trades are priced.

On *All accounts*, combined dollars only work when every account has a balance and the same R value.

10. Rule guard (prop firm mode)



Rule guard on a bound account.

Rule guard shows how far this account is from breaking its firm's rules. The drawdown and daily-loss bars show the **room left**: full and green when safe, shrinking and turning amber, then red, near the limit. The other bars fill

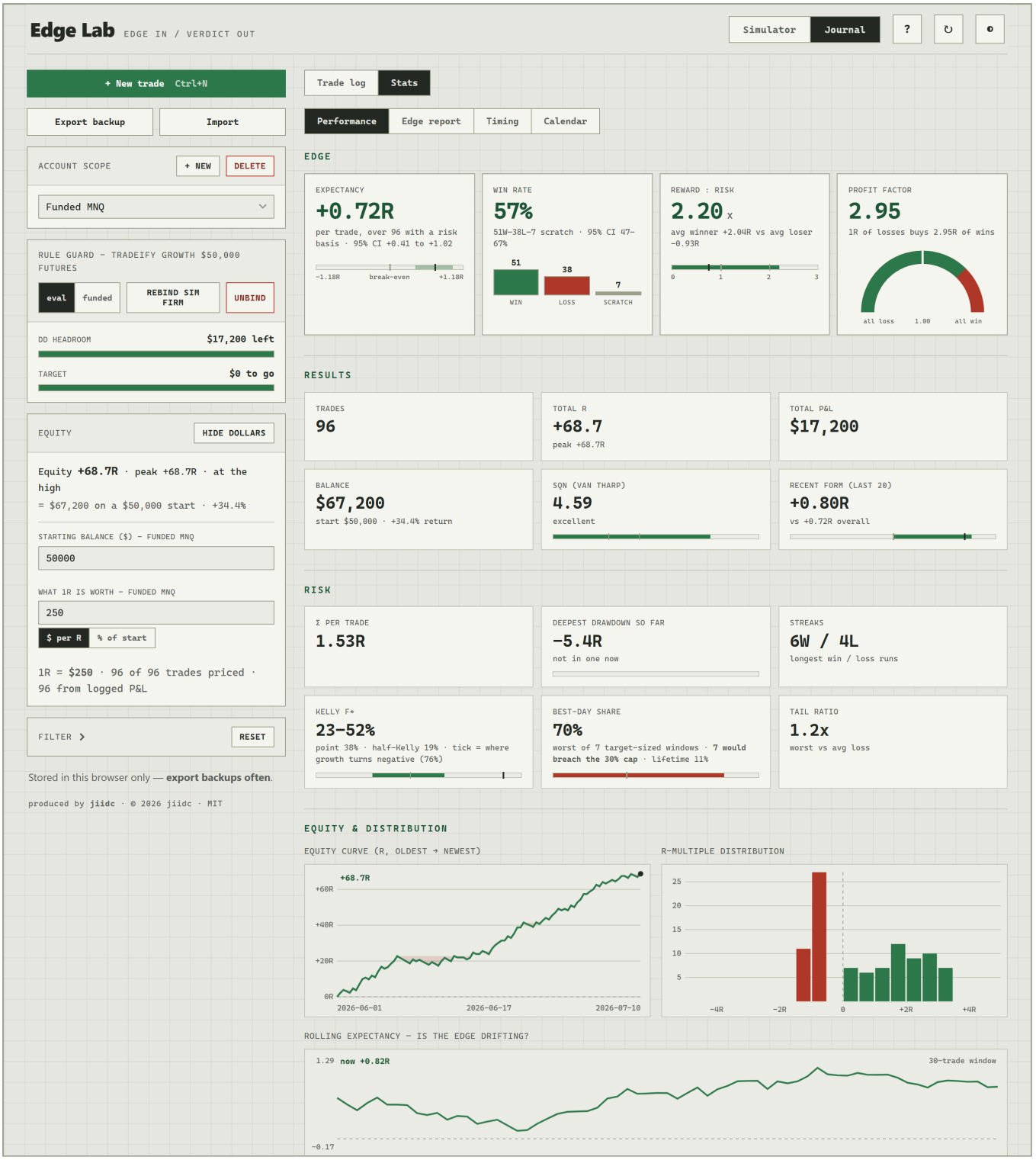
as you progress. It covers drawdown headroom, today's loss against the daily limit, distance to target, min days and consistency.

1. Set the firm's rules in the Simulator (section 18).
2. In Journal, pick **one** account in Account scope.
3. Click `Bind sim firm`. The firm is now stored with this account. `Rebind sim firm` replaces it. `Unbind` removes it.
4. Set the phase: `eval` or `funded`. Funded replaces the target meter with payout readiness and starts counting from the funding date.

> WHAT IT ASSUMES
>
> That this journal account **is** the prop account: its trades are the trades placed there, at those sizes. On a general journal covering everything you trade, the meters describe an account that does not exist. Add a separate account per prop account.
>
> Meters are computed from logged trade closes, not tick data. Keep a buffer on trailing rules.

The **day guard** line shows today's trades and R. It warns when you have 2+ losses in a row, 3+ losses today, or an elevated logged emotion. Stop for the day when you see it.

11. Stats — Performance



Stats → Performance.

How to read it

- The page is in sections: **Edge**, **Results**, **Risk**, **Equity & distribution**, **Exits & targets** and, last, **Prop odds**.
- **The four headline cards** are the edge: Expectancy, Win rate, Reward : risk, Profit factor. Expectancy is the one that grows the account. Win rate and reward:risk only mean something together.
- **Bands** (95% CI) under a number show how sure the sample is. If the expectancy band touches 0, luck is not ruled out yet.

- **The tile grid** adds trades, totals, balance, SQN, volatility, deepest drawdown, streaks, Kelly, recent form, best-day share and tail ratio. Each is defined in the glossary. These unlock at 8+ resolved trades.
- **Best-day share** matters for consistency rules. Many firms cap one day's share of profit near 30–50%.

Prop odds (prop firm mode)

Your journaled trades, resampled against the firm (the bound firm, or the Simulator's firm if none is bound), at the Decision tab's eval and funded risk. It shows pass odds, attempts and fees to fund, the chance to stay funded a year (the journal looks one year ahead), the chance a purchase ends in a payout, expected payout, and sample quality. It needs 10 resolved trades. Under 50 trades, treat every range as directional.

Charts

- **Equity curve** in R, oldest to newest, with dates along the bottom. The red shading is each drawdown below the running peak. **R-multiple distribution**: trade counts per half-R bucket, red losses, green wins.
- **Rolling expectancy** over a 30-trade window. A falling line means the edge is drifting or the market changed.

Exit management (needs MFE/MAE on 30+ trades)

- **Exit efficiency** = realised R ÷ best available R (MFE).
- **Avg MFE** is the average best point a trade reached. Compare it with your average winner: the gap is what your exits cost.
- **Avg heat (MAE)** is how far trades went against you on average. **Full-risk touches** near 100% mean stops fire late or get moved.
- **How far trades run — by session:** the band is the middle half of runs, the dark mark the median, the light mark the best 10%. **Kept** is the share of the run you realised.

Target sweep — what should the R:R be?

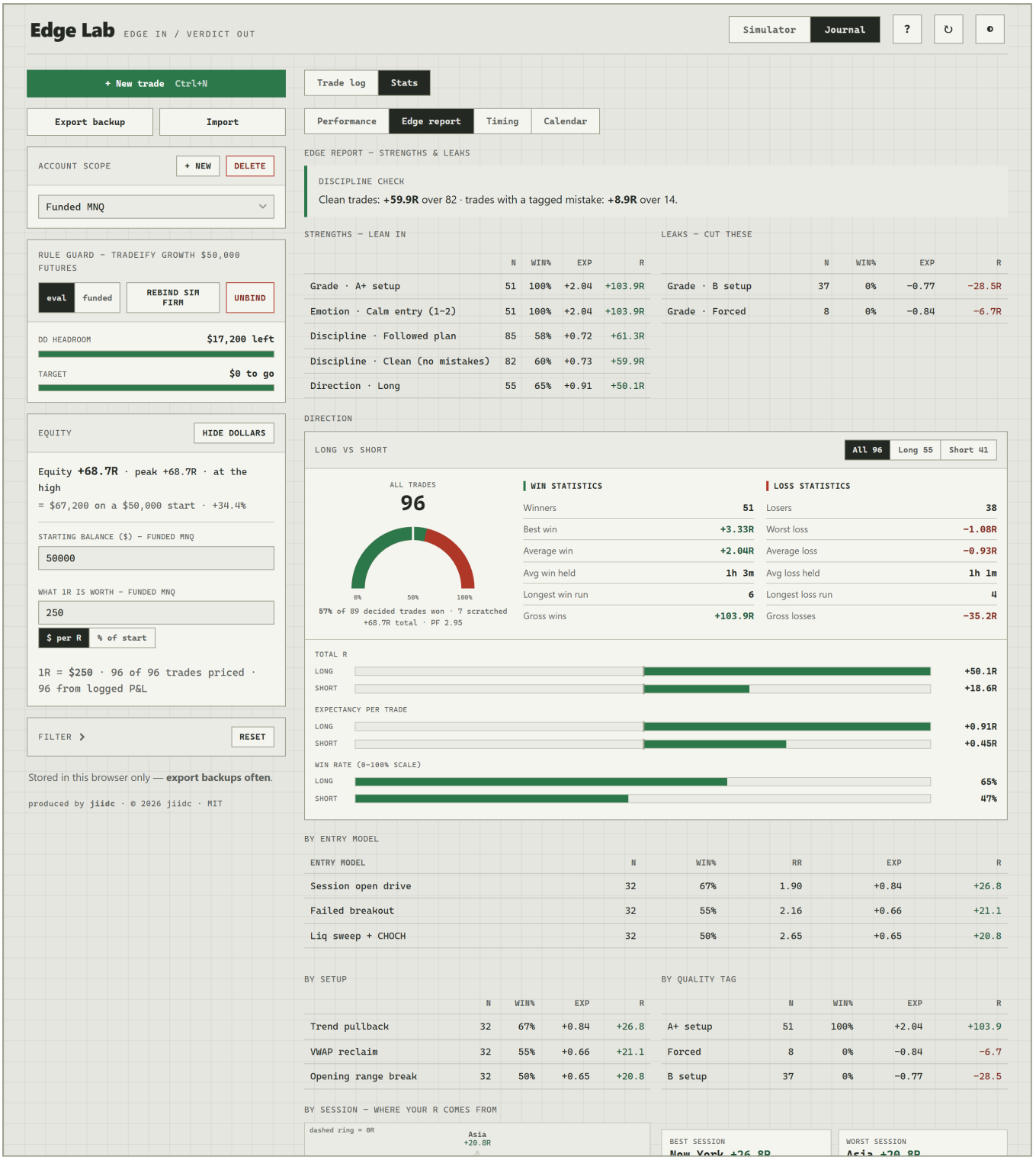
Your stop is 1R, so a target of **T** pays **+T** if the move reached T before coming back to the stop, and −1R if it did not. The sweep applies that to your record at every target and shows expectancy per trade.

1. Give every trade a **Planned R:R** (typed, or from entry/stop/target). If you traded one target throughout, type it in the **Planned R:R across this account** box and click `Set on n with none`. `Replace on all` overwrites every trade.
2. Log **Full run (R)** on your winners, at least 20 of them.
3. Read the **flat top**, not the single peak. Every target inside the flat top pays about the same; the lower end fills more often and pays sooner. The shaded range shows where 90% of resamples of your record put the best target.

> DON'T SET THE TARGET TO YOUR AVERAGE MFE
>
> The average sits above most trades. Every winner that peaks short of a higher target turns into a full −1R loss. Going from target P to T only pays if **p(T)·(T+1) > p(P)·(P+1)**. At a 48% win rate, moving 1.5R → 3R needs 63% of your current winners to also reach 3R.

The sweep starts at your lowest planned target: a trade that ran halfway and reversed is recorded only as a loss, so nothing below it can be measured. It assumes the stop stays put and that you would really hold to the new target. It follows the log filter, so filter to one setup or session to get a target for that subset. If runs are logged on under 80% of winners it warns you: logging runs mostly on big days biases it toward bigger targets.

12. Stats — Edge report



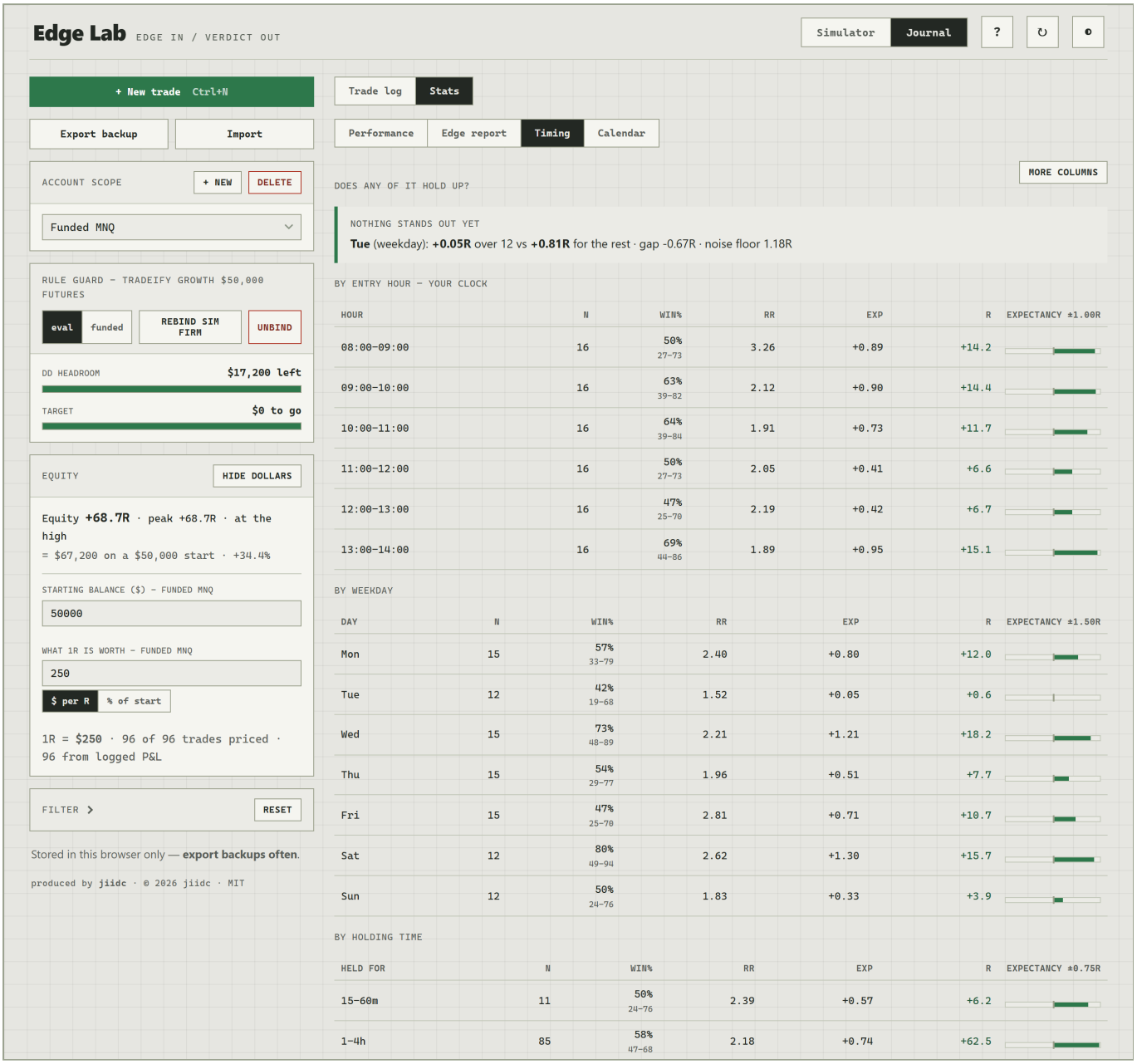
Stats → Edge report.

- **Discipline check:** clean trades against trades with a tagged mistake.
- **Strengths — lean in / Leaks — cut these:** every tag, grade, emotion, setup, session and direction with 4+ trades, ranked. **Click a row** to filter the log to those trades.
- **Direction:** long against short. Total R, expectancy and win rate side by side. The toggle picks which side's win/loss breakdown is shown. Under 8 trades a side, it's a hint, not a finding.
- **By entry model / setup / quality tag / session:** n, win%, RR (average winner ÷ average loser), expectancy, total R. Click an entry model row to filter the log. A row under 4 trades is noise.

- **By session radar:** where your R comes from. The dashed ring is 0R. Untagged trades count as Other. Open a trade and set its session to move it.

> READ IT AS HYPOTHESES
>
> With ~20 segments on screen, one will look best by chance. A leak is worth acting on when it has a real sample behind it and still holds after you log more trades.

13. Stats — Timing



Stats → Timing.

The same record cut by clock: entry hour, weekday, holding time, which trade of the day, how long you waited after a loss, and how busy the day was.

"Does any of it hold up?"

The box at the top tests whether any one bucket really differs from the rest. It needs 30+ trades on an axis in 2+ buckets of 4+. It reports the most striking bucket, its gap against the rest, and the **noise floor**: the gap that

picking the best of that many buckets produces on a record with no timing edge at all. **Stands out** means the gap cleared both the 90% band and the noise floor. **Nothing stands out yet** means it didn't. Log more trades in the thin buckets rather than changing your trading.

Even when a bucket stands out, an hour is *when* you traded, not *what*. Check the setup, session and direction mix inside it on the Edge report before changing anything.

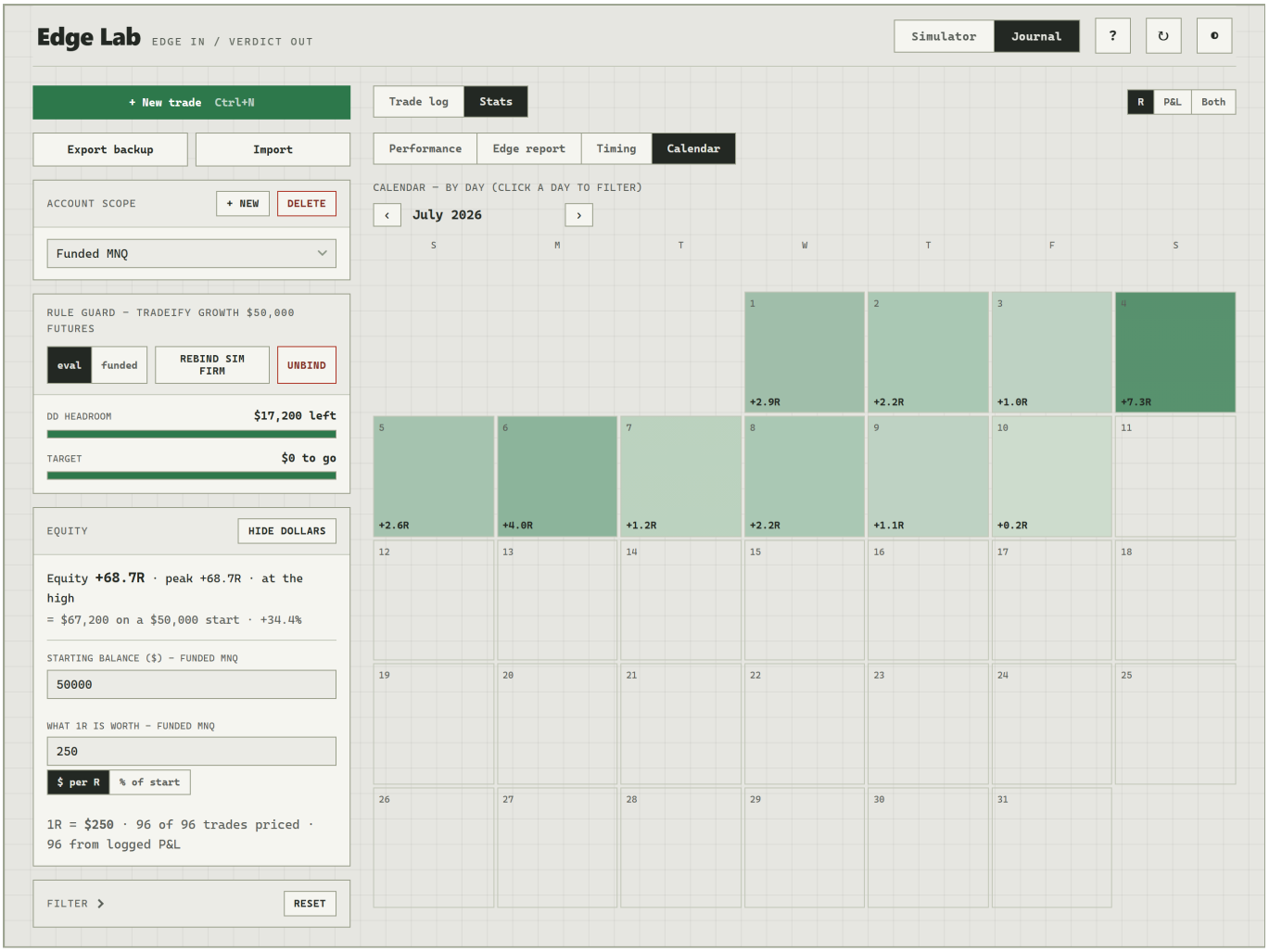
Columns

Each table shows n, win%, RR, expectancy and total R by default. `More columns` adds holding times, planned R:R, kept, and ran-to.

`win% (small range)`	Win rate and its range.
RR	Average winner ÷ average loser, in R.
`held / win / loss held`	Median holding time. Needs exit times.
`ran to (won) / (lost)`	Median MFE, split by outcome. It says where price got, not whether you could have stayed in: MFE and MAE are stored with no order between them. Treat it as a reason to test a bigger target, not as a backtest of one.
`expectancy bar`	Expectancy per trade with its band.

- Hours are read straight from the times you logged, in your timezone. For market sessions use the session tag.
- **Holding time is never tested.** Winners run to target and are held longer, losers stop out fast, so long holds win by construction. It describes your trades; it is not an instruction to hold longer.
- **Which trade of the day** matters because the daily loss limit ends prop accounts. A decay down this column is a stopping rule, after it clears the test above.
- **After a loss** measures the gap from a losing exit to your next entry on the same account. It needs exit times on losers.
- **By how busy the day was** has one row per day (median day, green days, total R), not per trade.
- Blank cells mean the data isn't logged: holding time needs exit times, RR/kept needs a planned R:R, ran-to needs MFE.

14. Stats — Calendar



Stats → Calendar.

A month grid tinted by each day's result. Use `‹` / `›` to change month. The unit switch shows R, P&L or both.

15. Backups and your data

- **Desktop app:** the journal is `journal.db` (SQLite) plus screenshots in `images\`, inside `Documents\Edge Lab\`. `Open folder` in the rail reveals it.
- **Browser version:** trades live in that browser only. Export backups often.
- `Export backup` writes a JSON file of trades, settings and screenshots. With **one account** selected in Account scope it asks: that account only, or all accounts. The file name says which. If a screenshot cannot be read, the message says how many are missing from the backup. The desktop app also makes a silent weekly backup of everything into `exports\`.
- `Import` reads a backup file or a CSV (below). **Where the trades go depends on Account scope:**

ACCOUNT SCOPE	IMPORTED TRADES GO TO	REPLACE REMOVES
`One account`	That account, whatever account the file names. Your other accounts are not touched.	Only that account's trades
`All accounts`	The accounts named in the file (created if missing)	Every trade in every account

  - **Merge** adds the file's trades. Trades already in the account are skipped, and the message says how many. So importing the same file twice adds nothing, while importing it into a *different* account gives that account its own copy, with its own screenshots.
  - **Replace** removes the trades shown above and keeps the file's. A copy of your **whole** journal is saved first (desktop: `exports\before-replace-….json`; browser: a download). If that copy cannot be saved, nothing is replaced. For 20 seconds afterwards, `Undo` puts everything back.
  - **Settings:** your accounts keep their own starting balance, R value and phase. A file only fills in what an account has not set yet: with one account selected, from the file's account; with All accounts, for the file's accounts.
- `Load sample journal` appears on an empty journal. It imports the 1,000-trade sample.

The exports folder

FILE	WRITTEN BY	KEPT
`edge-lab-journal-….json`	Export backup	Always. The app never deletes these.
`auto-backup-….json`	The weekly automatic backup	The newest 8
`before-replace-….json`	Import → Replace, before it changes anything	The newest 20
`edge-lab-report-….png`	Validate → Save as image	Always

To restore any of them: `Import`, pick the file, then **Merge** (adds back what is missing) or **Replace**.

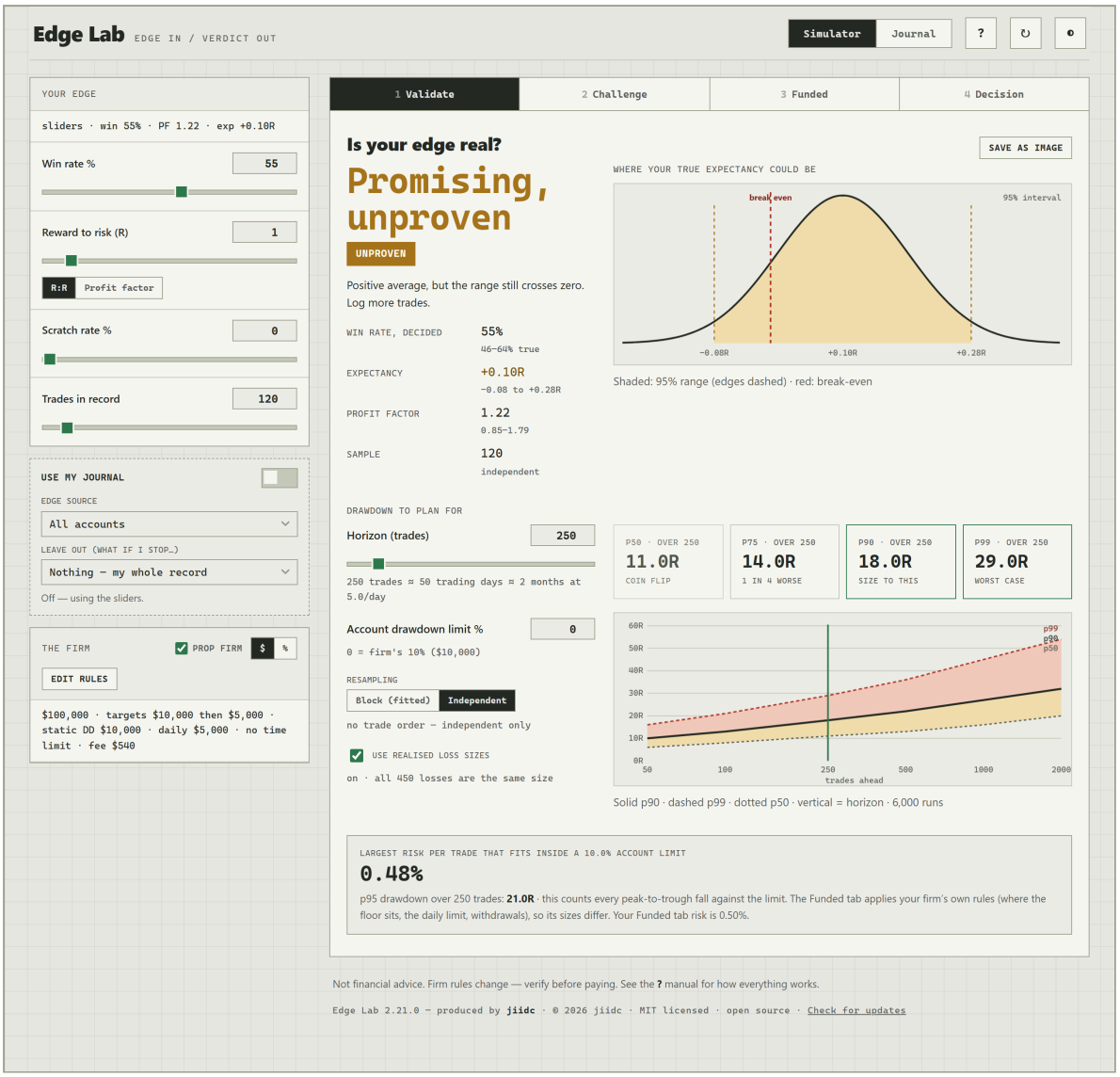
Importing a CSV

Any spreadsheet export works if it has a header row. Two columns are required: a **Date** and a result, either **R** or **P&L** together with **Risk**. Column names are matched loosely, and comma, semicolon and tab separated files all read.

COLUMN	ALSO RECOGNISED AS
`Date (required)`	Datetime, Trade date, Open date, Open time, Entry time. `2025-03-04 09:31`, `03/04/2025 2:05 PM`, `2025.03.04`, `Mar 4, 2025`, `04-Mar-2025` and Excel serial numbers all read. A separate **Time** column is joined to a date-only Date column.
`R`	R multiple, Result R, Net R. Stored as a typed R.
`P&L`	PnL, P/L, Profit, Net P&L, Net profit. With **Risk**, R = P&L ÷ Risk.
`Risk`	Risk $, Risk amount, 1R
`Optional`	Exit time (a bare clock time counts as the entry's day), Setup (or Tag, Strategy), Direction (long/short, buy/sell), Symbol, Account, Session, Notes, Fees. A unit in brackets is read: `P&L (R)` is an R column.

- **Day or month first?** Read off the whole file: a first number over 12 means day first. If every date could go either way, the app asks.
- **No Account column:** trades go to the account in scope (or the first account).
- **P&L without Risk:** the trades import, but have no R until you set what 1R is worth for that account (Equity).
- Importing the same file twice with **Merge** adds nothing the second time.

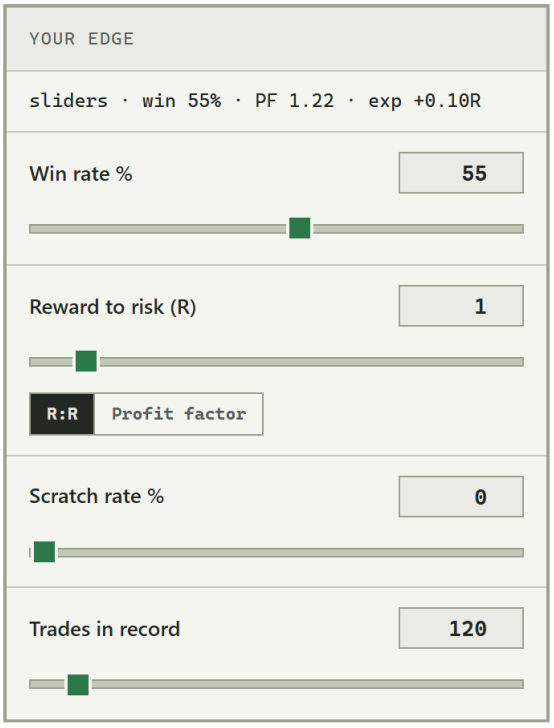
Part 3 — Simulator



The Simulator: your edge and the firm on the left, four tabs on the right.

Every Simulator number comes from Monte Carlo: your edge is played trade by trade, thousands of times (against the firm's rules, in prop firm mode). Internally everything is in R, scaled by your risk per trade, then shown in dollars.

16. Your edge: sliders or journal

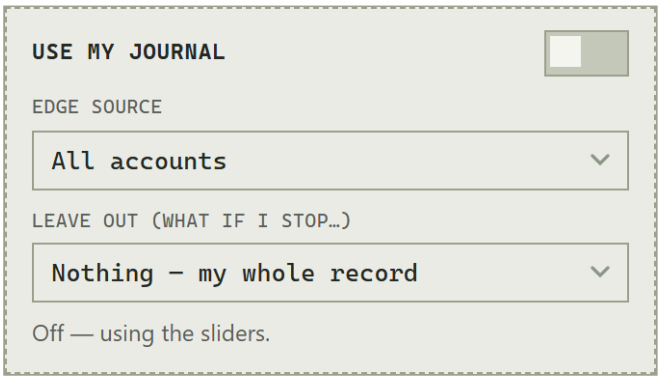


Your edge.

Sliders (default)

`Win rate %`	Share of **decided** trades that win. Scratches are outside it, the same as in the journal.
`Reward to risk (R)`	Average winner in R. Toggle `Profit factor` to enter PF instead.
`Scratch rate %`	Share of **all** trades that close at 0R. Scratches burn days without moving the account, which matters for time limits, subscriptions and payout windows.
`Trades in record`	How big a sample the numbers stand for. Controls how wide the ranges on Validate are.

Use my journal



Use my journal.

1. Turn on `Use my journal`. It needs 10+ resolved trades with an R basis.
2. Pick the **Edge source**: one account, or all.

Every tab now resamples your real trades instead of the sliders. The panel shows a **FROM JOURNAL** tag and its inputs lock, showing your record's numbers. Trades without a stop or Risk $ are left out; the line under the

switch says how many.

> SEVERAL ACCOUNTS, ONE SIGNAL
>
> If you fire the same trades into several accounts, pooling them counts one decision two or three times and makes every range look more certain than it is. Set Edge source to a single account. Validate flags pooled and mirrored trades.

17. Leave out (what if I stop…)

With Use my journal on, **Leave out** removes one segment of your record (the same segments as the Edge report, e.g. "Direction · Short"). Every tab then recomputes without it. The box below shows:

- the change in expectancy with its 90% band;
- the **noise floor**: how much cutting the most striking of that many segments moves a record when nothing is going on;
- a verdict: **Stands out**, **Inside the noise floor**, **Band includes zero** or **Barely moves the record**;
- a warning if survival drops. Fewer trades is a shorter record, not automatically a safer one.

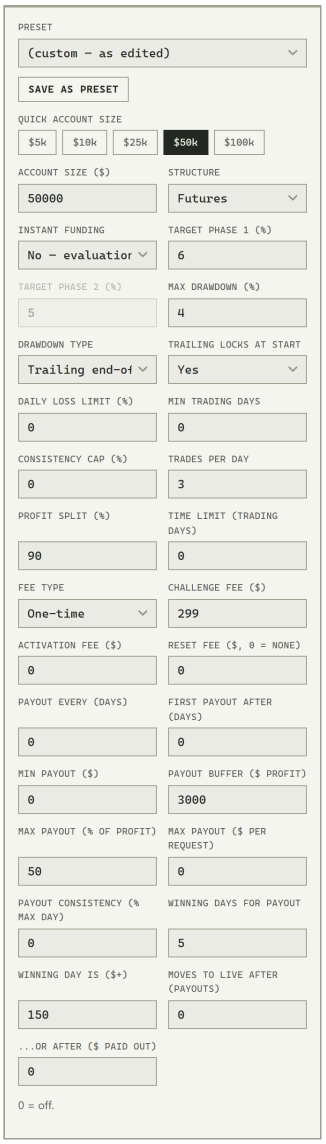
Even "Stands out" is a hypothesis: you picked the segment by looking at these same trades. Trade it forward before believing it. Each segment you test is another look at the same record, so Validate widens its ranges for every look (see "Multiple looks" in section 23). Clearing the cut does not undo that. If the cut leaves fewer than 30 trades, it is not applied.

18. Your account, and prop firm mode

The panel under **Use my journal** describes the account you trade. It has two modes, switched by the `Prop firm` tick box in its header:

- **Off (default): Your account.** Set the account size, the most you can lose (max drawdown) and how many trades you take a day. The Simulator shows the Validate tab only; the Journal hides the rule guard and prop odds.
- **On: The firm.** Every firm rule below becomes editable, the Challenge, Funded and Decision tabs appear, and the Journal adds the rule guard and prop odds.

The rest of this section describes prop firm mode.



The firm editor.

1. Click **Edit rules** in The firm.
2. Pick a **Preset** (2-step, 1-phase, Futures trailing, or one you saved) as a starting point.
3. Set **every field** to match your actual firm. 0 turns a rule off.
4. Optional: **Save as preset** to reuse it. **Delete preset** removes a saved one.

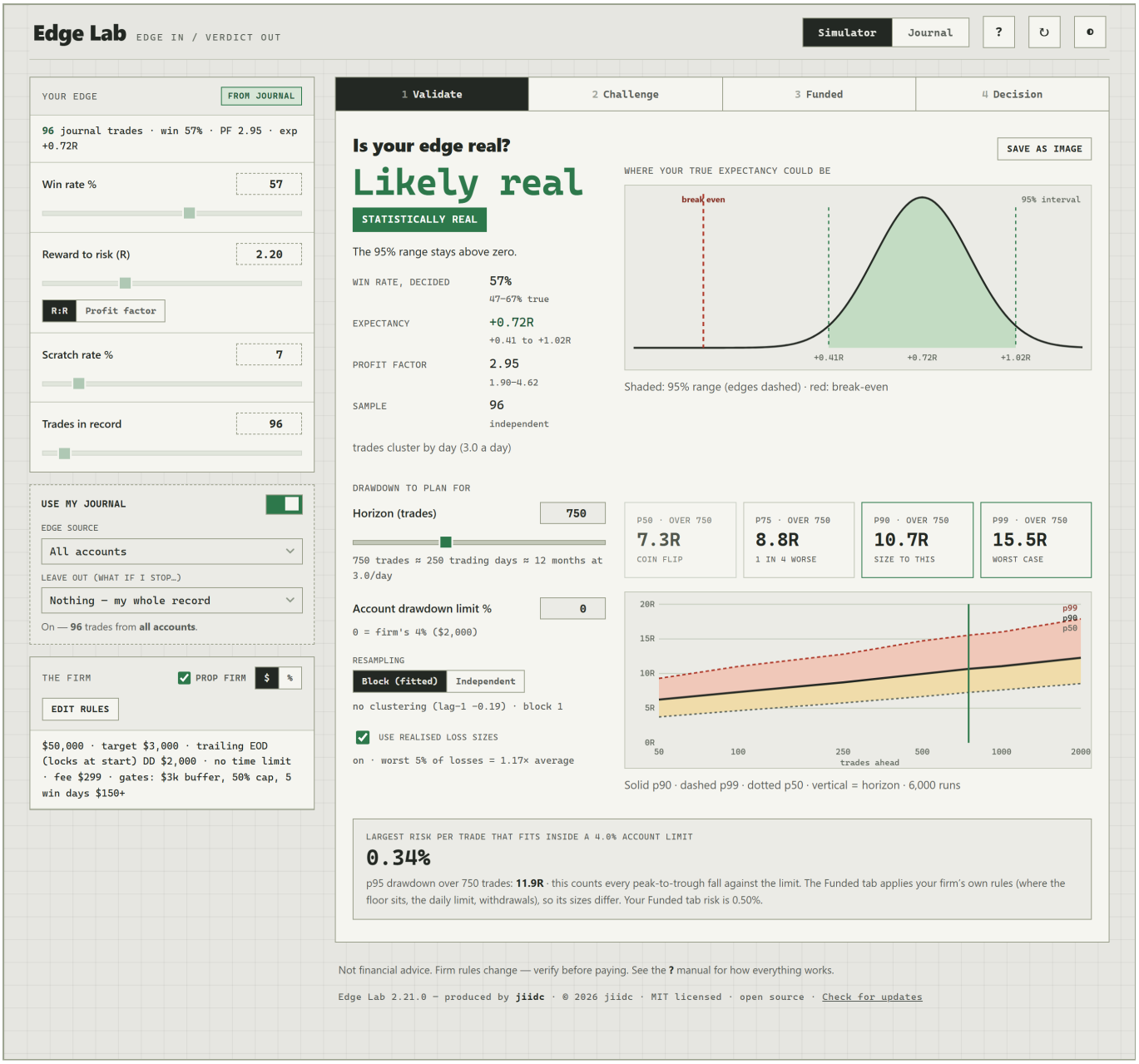
The **$** / **%** switch shows the firm summary and the Funded tab in dollars or % of account. Decision is always in dollars.

FIELD	MEANING
Account size / quick chips	The funded account's size.
Structure	2-step, 1-phase or futures (one phase).
Instant funding	Yes = the fee buys the funded account outright. No evaluation; targets don't apply; the fee is a certain cost.
Target phase 1 / 2 (%)	Profit target per phase. Phase 2 starts from a fresh balance with full drawdown room.
Max drawdown (%)	Distance from the high-water mark (or start) to the floor.

`Drawdown type`	**Static**: floor fixed below the starting balance. **Trailing intraday**: floor follows the peak tick. **Trailing end-of-day**: floor follows the daily close.
`Trailing locks at start`	Yes = the trailing floor stops rising once it reaches the starting balance.
`Daily loss limit (%)`	Max loss in one day.
`Min trading days`	Days required before a pass counts.
`Consistency cap (%)`	Max share of total profit one day may contribute during the evaluation.
`Trades per day`	Your pace, 1–20. It sets when daily limits reset, how long a day is and how many trades fit in a year, so it changes almost every number.
`Profit split (%)`	Your share of payouts.
`Time limit (trading days)`	Days allowed per phase, in **trading** days (30 calendar days ≈ 21). 0 = none.
`Fee type / Challenge fee`	One-time, or monthly until passed (a subscription keeps charging while the evaluation runs).
`Activation fee`	One-off fee when the evaluation converts to funded.
`Reset fee`	Discounted re-attempt price after a failed evaluation (one-time-fee firms only). 0 = full fee every time.
`Payout every / first payout after`	Trading days between payout windows (0 = on demand) and before the first one.
`Min payout ($)`	Minimum withdrawal. Only matters once it exceeds 5% of the account.
`Payout buffer ($ profit)`	Profit the account must hold before any withdrawal (e.g. $50k account pays only above $53k = $3,000 buffer).
`Max payout (% of profit)`	Most of current profit one withdrawal may take; the rest stays at the firm.
`Max payout ($ per request)`	Fixed dollar ceiling per payout (the first tier if the firm tiers it).
`Payout consistency (% max day)`	Largest share of profit-since-last-payout any one day may contribute. A big day blocks withdrawals until later profit dilutes it; it does not fail the account.
`Winning days for payout / Winning day is ($+)`	E.g. 5 days closing up $150+ before a payout can be requested. The count resets after each payout.
`Moves to live after (payouts) / … or after ($ paid out)`	Many firms move a simulated funded account to a live one after a number of payouts or a total paid out, and close the sim account. The funded stage ends there, paid; a new evaluation keeps the slot going. Whichever comes first ends it. 0 = no such rule.

> CHECK THE RULES YOURSELF
>
> Presets are starting points. Prop firm rules change often. Confirm every field on the firm's own site before you pay.

19. Validate — is your edge real?



Validate.

Steps

1. Set your edge (sliders or journal).
2. Read the verdict: **Likely real**, **Promising, unproven**, **Not enough data** or **No edge**.
3. Set the drawdown **Horizon** (how many trades ahead you plan for) and, optionally, your own **Account drawdown limit %** (0 = the firm's).
4. Read the **largest risk per trade** box at the bottom.
5. To share the result, click `Save as image`: the verdict, its numbers and both charts on one PNG. The desktop app saves it in `exports\`; the browser version downloads it.

Reading the verdict

- **Likely real**: the 95% range for expectancy stays above zero.

- **Promising, unproven**: the average is positive, but the range still crosses zero. More trades will settle it.
- **Not enough data**: under 30 trades. Aim for 100+. Everything below still prints; only the verdict holds back.

Each figure (win rate, expectancy, profit factor) has its range underneath. **Sample** shows the trade count and how many **independent** observations they amount to. Trades that cluster by day, setup or account are not separate draws, so every range is computed from the effective count.

The **curve** is where your true average trade could sit. The shaded band is the 95% range, with its edges marked by dashed lines in the band's colour; the red dashed line is break-even. If the band crosses break-even, you cannot yet rule out having no edge.

Drawdown to plan for

Maximum drawdown grows with how long you trade (roughly with log of trades), so every number names its horizon and percentile. Your record is resampled first, then the future simulated from each resample, so the answer covers the edge you might actually have, not just the one you measured.

`p50 — coin flip`	The median. Not a plan.
`p75 — 1 in 4 worse`	One run in four is deeper.
`p90 — size to this`	The sizing anchor.
`p99 — worst case`	The bad year. Size to survive it.

On the chart: solid line p90, dashed p99, dotted p50; the vertical line is your horizon. Every point is the same edge. The curve rises because a longer run has more chances to go wrong.

- **Resampling — Block (fitted)** keeps runs of consecutive trades together, so clustered losses survive the resampling. The block length is fitted from your record's lag-1 autocorrelation. **Independent** draws each trade separately and understates drawdown when losses cluster. The line under it shows the fitted block and, if clustered, what independent draws would have said.
- **Use realised loss sizes**: on = losses are resampled at the sizes you actually logged, so a stop that filled at −1.4R can happen again. Off = every loss is your average loss. If all your logged losses are the same size, your journal records planned losses, not fills.

Largest risk per trade

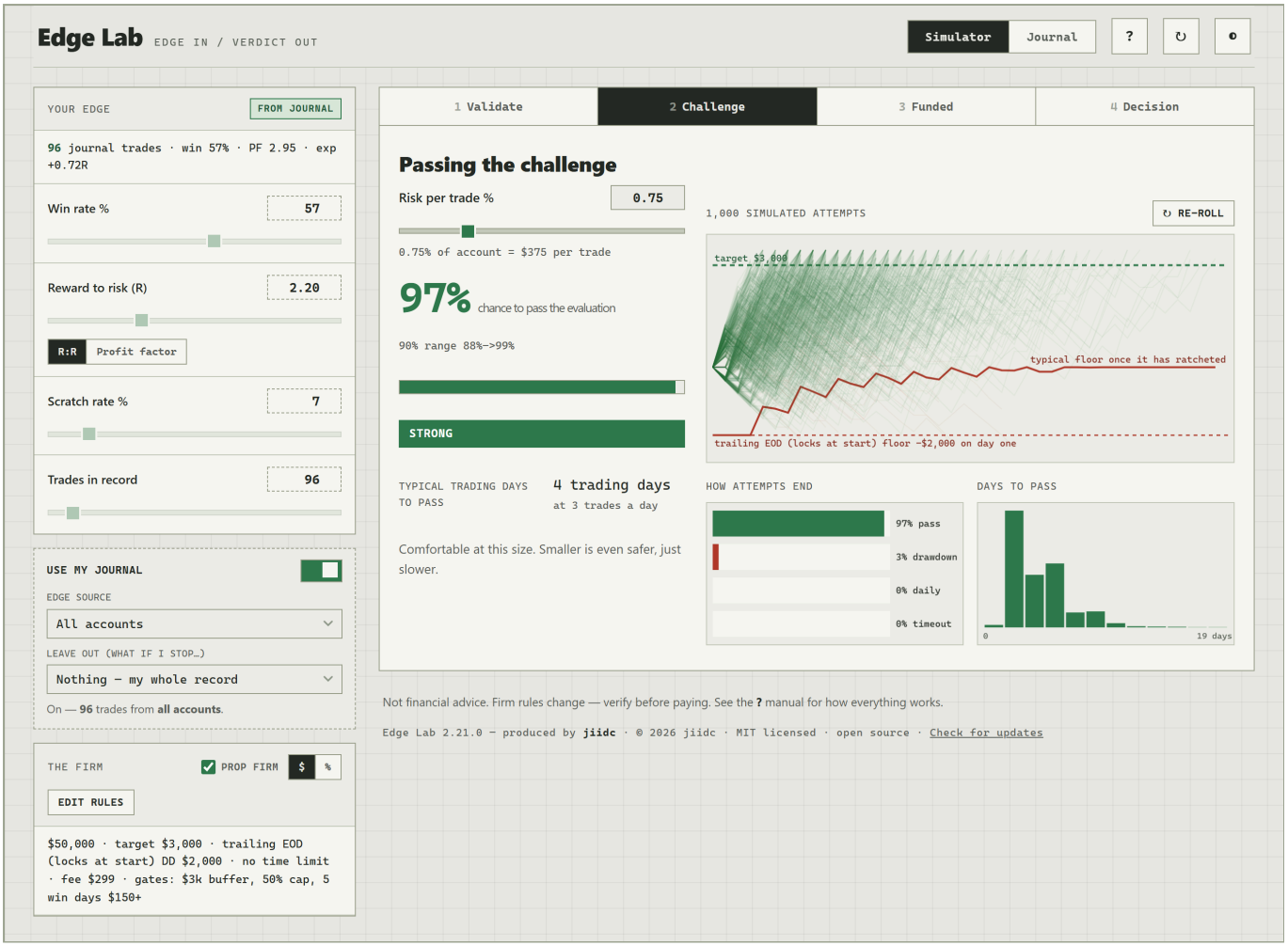
The risk per trade at which the p95 drawdown over your horizon exactly fills the account limit. It counts **every** peak-to-trough fall against the limit, with no daily limit and no withdrawals. One run in twenty is still worse, so treat it as a ceiling, not a target.

In prop firm mode the box also quotes the Funded tab's **Balanced** size. The two differ on purpose: the Funded tab applies your firm's own rules (a static floor lets you give back profit above the starting balance; a daily limit adds a cliff; withdrawals move the floor), so it answers a different question about the same edge.

Warnings on this tab

- **Multiple looks**: you have tested several subsets with Leave out, so ranges are widened (each is a stricter interval, so the whole family still carries 95%).
- **Pooled accounts**: the edge pools several accounts; mirrored trades (same instrument and direction within 5 minutes in different accounts) are discounted.
- **The full record, for comparison**: shown whenever a Leave-out cut is active.

20. Challenge — will it pass? (prop firm mode)



Challenge.

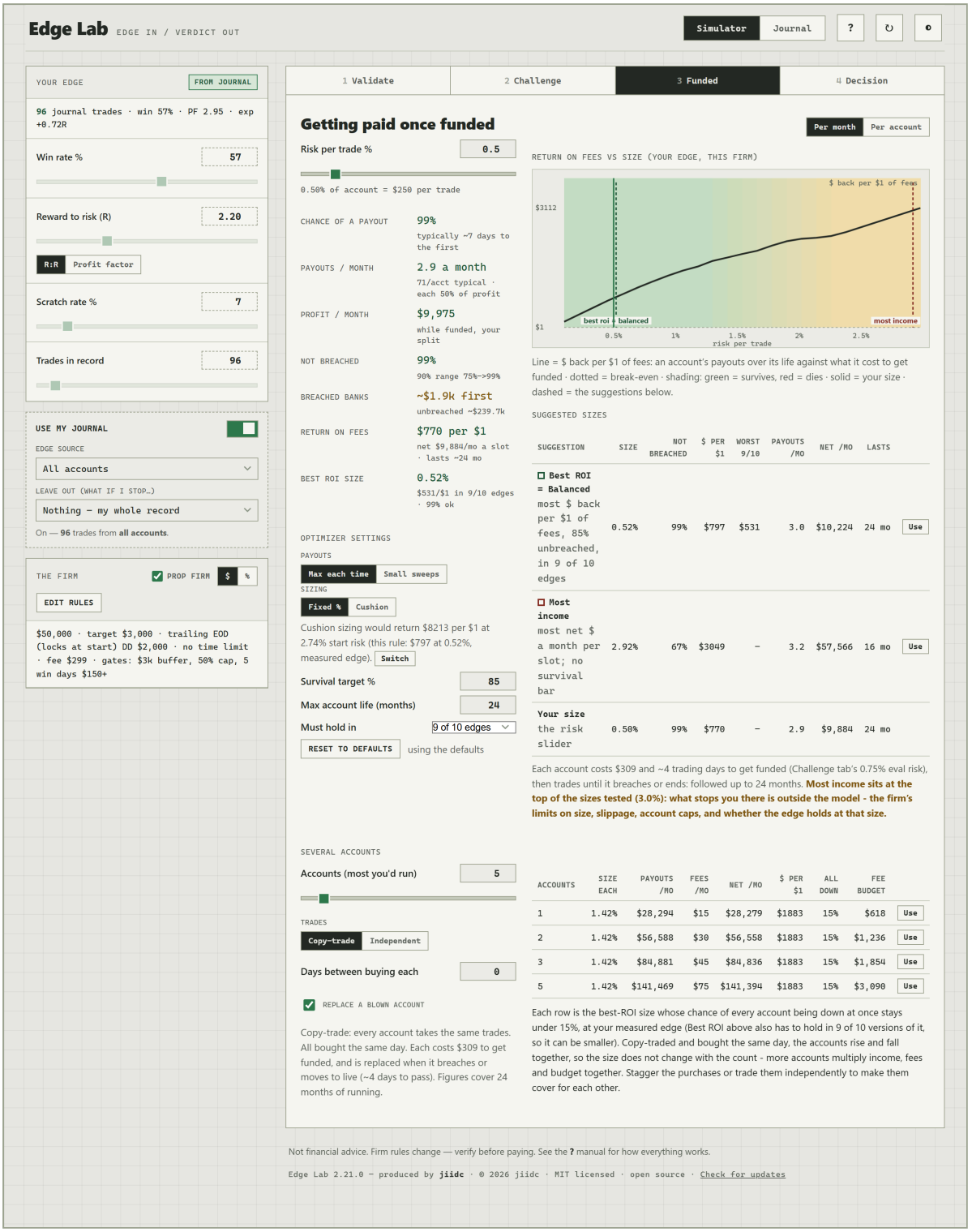
1. Set **Risk per trade %** for the evaluation.
2. Read **chance to pass**, its 90% range, and typical trading days to pass.
3. Read the one-line advice under it (see below).
4. Use `↻ re-roll` to draw a new sample of paths. On a 2-step firm, `Phase 1` / `Phase 2` switches which phase is drawn.

- **Paths chart:** each line is a live trade-by-trade walk of your edge against the rules. The pass figure itself averages 2,600 attempts.
- **How attempts end:** pass, drawdown, daily limit, timeout. On a 2-step firm the faded end of a bar is failure in phase 2.
- **Days to pass:** trading days, not calendar days; the total across both phases on a 2-step. The time limit applies per phase.
- **Pass phase 1 × then pass phase 2** multiply into the headline on a 2-step firm.

ADVICE LINE	WHAT TO DO
`Too big. Smaller risk lifts these odds a lot.`	Lower risk per trade.

`Smaller is worse here…`	A smaller size is slower, and the time limit or min days is what fails you. Don't size down; the clock is the constraint.
`Size isn't the lever.`	The firm's rules or your edge decide it. Try another firm or improve the edge.
`Phase 1/2 is the harder gate`	Which phase kills most attempts on a 2-step firm.

21. Funded — the sizing optimizer (prop firm mode)



Funded.

This tab treats funded accounts as a business. Each **account** is bought (the cost to get funded), passes, withdraws, and then **ends**: it breaches, the firm moves it to live (the sim account is closed), or the modelled life runs out. A new account then takes its place. The tab searches every risk size for your edge and your firm and asks what each size returns on what the account cost. There is no calendar year in it: a funded account rarely lives exactly one. Everything works out of the box on default settings, and every setting can be changed.

1. Pick **Per month** (default) or **Per account** at the top. Every money figure and table follows it.
2. Read **Suggested sizes** under the chart and click **Use** on the one you want: it sets **Risk per trade %**.
3. Optional: set the firm's move-to-live rule in **Edit rules**, change how you run the account under **Optimizer settings**, or plan several accounts under **Several accounts**.

Return on fees

Per account: what it pays out over its whole life, divided by what it cost to get funded (fees, retries and resets, from the Challenge tab at its eval risk). **$5 back per $1** means every dollar spent getting the account came back five times as payouts. A size that blows accounts up early pays little before each one ends, so it returns little per dollar.

Net / month is the account's net (payouts minus its cost) spread over the time to pass plus its funded life: what one account slot earns a month when each ended account is replaced.

Suggested sizes

SUGGESTION	WHAT IT PICKS
`Best ROI`	The most $ back per $1 of fees that still holds in the set share of plausible versions of your edge (default 9 of 10), among the sizes that keep your **survival target** (default 85% of accounts ending without a breach, at your measured edge and in 9 of 10 versions of it). Of the sizes within 3% of that best, the smallest. This is the default recommendation.
`Balanced`	The largest size that keeps your survival target, at your measured edge **and** in the set share of plausible versions of it. Best ROI is never above it; often they are the same size and share a row.
`Max payout`	Shown when the firm caps each payout in dollars. Past some size an account already takes the full cap at almost every payout window, and more size only adds risk. This is the smallest size that takes the max payout (within 3%) as often as any size does. To earn more, add accounts, not size.
`Most income`	The most net $ a month per account slot, at your measured edge, with no survival bar. With cheap evaluations this can be a size that blows up often and is replaced; its survival and its lower return per fee dollar sit beside it so you can see that.
`Your size`	The risk slider, for comparison.

Each row shows the size, **Not breached** (accounts that end by moving to live or reaching the modelled life, not by breaching), **$ per $1** at your measured edge, **Worst 9/10** (the return in 9 of 10 plausible versions of your edge), payouts, **Net**, and how long an account **Lasts** funded on average.

If **Most income** sits at the top of the sizes tested (3%), the tab says so: what stops you there is outside the model (the firm's limits on size, slippage, account caps, and whether the edge holds at that size).

Optimizer settings

`Payouts: Max each time`	(default) Every withdrawal is the firm's maximum, on the firm's own payout schedule (**Payout every** / **First payout after**), never more often than weekly. With a dollar cap, the request waits until the whole cap is available and takes all of it. With only a % cap, it takes the most that rule allows. Uncapped, it takes all profit above the drawdown cushion. The cushion is always kept: a withdrawal never takes the account closer to its floor than a full drawdown.
`Payouts: Small sweeps`	Up to 5% of the account every week, cut by the firm's caps (the model before 2.20). It caps income at about one payout a week whatever the size.
`Sizing: Fixed %`	(default) The same % of the account on every trade.
`Sizing: Cushion`	Risk scales with your distance to the drawdown floor. **Risk per trade %** becomes the risk at a full cushion: less in a drawdown, more (up to 2×) once profit sits above a locked or static floor. Sized too big, this decays rather than blows up: each loss shrinks the next trade, and the account limps on too small to earn. The line under the switch compares the two rules on your edge (both at your survival target) and offers **Switch** when the other one returns more.
`Survival target %`	The share of accounts that must end without a breach, for Best ROI and Balanced (default 85), and, as 1 minus it, how often every account may be down at once under Several accounts.
`Max account life (months)`	The longest an account is followed when nothing else ends it (default 24). A firm's move-to-live rule usually ends it sooner. An account still trading at this point counts as ended without a breach. Longer is a truer lifetime but slower to compute.
`Must hold in`	How sure: 8 of 10, **9 of 10** (default) or 19 of 20 plausible versions of your edge.
`Reset to defaults`	Puts every setting back. The line beside it says whether you are on the defaults.

The payout and sizing settings apply everywhere funded numbers appear: this tab, Decision, and the journal's prop odds.

The tiles

`Chance of a payout`	Chance of at least one withdrawal before the account ends, including the first-payout wait and minimum.
`Payouts / month`	Payouts per funded month (per account: typical and average count over its life), and what one payout is under the payout setting.
`Profit / month`	Cash withdrawn per funded month, averaged over every account including the ones that breached (per account: over its whole life). In $ mode it is after your split; in % mode, before.
`Not breached`	Accounts that end without breaching. With a move-to-live rule, the share moved to live is shown under it. Green when it clears your survival target.
`Breached banks`	Median cash an account that breaches had withdrawn before it died, beside an unbreached one's. Shown when some accounts breach.
`Return on fees`	$ back per $1 of fees at your size, the slot's net per month, and how long an account lasts funded.

`Best ROI size`	The Best ROI suggestion, with its return in 9 of 10 edges and the share of accounts not breached.

Chart: $ back per $1 of fees against size, shaded by the share not breached (green) or breached (red). The dotted line is break-even ($1 back per $1). Every suggestion is a dashed line with its name; the solid line is your size. Hover for the numbers at any size.

Several accounts

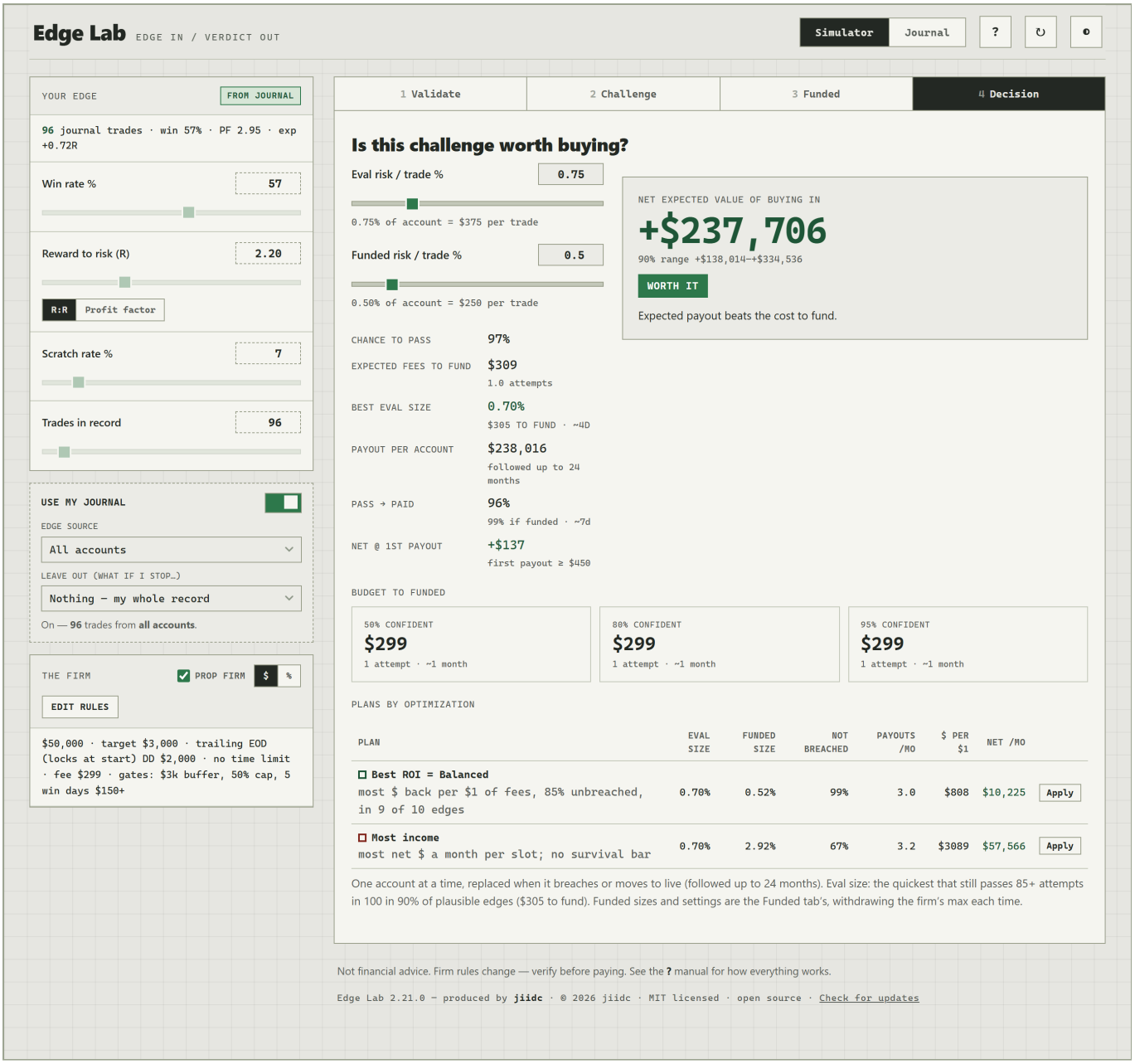
On average, return per fee dollar does not depend on how many accounts you run: payouts and fees both scale with the count. What the count changes is how often **every** account is down at once, and the fee budget. The table covers **1, 2, 3, 5, 10, 20, 30 and 50** accounts, up to **Accounts (most you'd run)** (1 to 50), over the max account life. For each count it shows the best-ROI size whose chance of every account being down at once stays under 1 − your survival target, at your measured edge. That is why its sizes can sit above Best ROI, which must also hold in 9 of 10 versions of your edge.

`Copy-trade / Independent`	**Copy-trade** (default): every account takes the same trades. **Independent**: each account trades its own stream from the same edge (different strategies or times).
`Days between buying each`	0 = all bought the same day. Copy-traded accounts bought the same day rise and fall together, so the size does not change with the count. Staggered accounts sit at different distances from their floors when the same bad run arrives.
`Replace a blown account`	Buys a new evaluation when an account breaches or moves to live; it trades again after the expected time to pass and costs the expected cost to get funded.
`Fees`	Every account bought plus every replacement.
`All down`	Share of runs with a moment when no funded account is up.
`Fee budget`	Fees over the whole period in a bad run (95th percentile): what to set aside for evaluations.

The line under the table says whether more accounts let each run bigger. Grey rows with a red all-down figure mean no size keeps every account from being down at once that rarely; the safest size is shown.

> WHAT THIS MODEL ASSUMES
>
> Payout gates (buffer, % cap, $ cap, consistency, winning days) and the move-to-live rule are applied exactly as the firm would. What a live account pays after the move is not counted. Trades are drawn independently, and every day trades your full trades-per-day with no stopping for the day, which is what puts a cliff where a few losing trades cross a daily loss limit. A replacement's evaluation is priced by its expected time and cost, not re-simulated, and replacements are assumed always available. Firms that limit how many accounts you hold, or that refuse payouts, are outside the model.

22. Decision — is it worth buying? (prop firm mode)



Decision.

1. Set **Eval risk / trade %** and **Funded risk / trade %**, or click **Apply** on one of the **Plans by optimization** to set both. These two also drive the journal's prop odds.
2. Read **Net expected value of buying in** and its verdict: **Worth it**, **Not worth it**, or **Could go either way** (graded on the low end of the 90% range).
3. If it's not worth it, read the line under the verdict: it names an eval size that would make it pay, or says no size will.

`Chance to pass`	End-to-end pass odds (both phases on a 2-step).
`Expected fees to fund`	Average cost to get funded, re-attempting until you pass: fees, resets, subscription months, activation.

`Best eval size`	The eval size that funds you for the least money, measured on this firm; where several cost the same, the quickest that still passes 85+ attempts in 100 in the Funded tab's share of plausible versions of your edge (default 9 of 10).
`Payout per account`	Expected withdrawals over the funded account's whole life (until it breaches, moves to live, or reaches the max account life), after split, under the Funded tab's settings.
`Pass → paid`	Chance one purchase ends with money withdrawn; in brackets, the odds once funded and typical days to the first payout.
`Net @ 1st payout`	Where you stand the day of your first withdrawal: the odds of getting there × one payout, minus the cost to fund. Under max payouts with no dollar cap, the first payout is at least the amount shown.

Budget to funded shows what to set aside to be 50%, 80% or 95% sure of getting funded, with attempts and months. They assume attempts are independent.

Plans by optimization pairs the best eval size with each Funded-tab suggestion (Best ROI, Balanced, Max payout, Most income). Each is priced per account at that eval size: **$ per $1** of fees, and the net per month or per account. The sizes and settings are the Funded tab's, so the two tabs always name the same sizes.

The net EV assumes your edge is real (check Validate) and that you re-attempt until funded, over one funded account's life. It ignores time value and taxes. Discounted resets are priced only when a Reset fee is set.

23. Messages you may see

MESSAGE	MEANING / WHAT TO DO
`Needs 10 resolved trades`	Use my journal, prop odds: log more trades with a stop or Risk $.
`More stats at 8+ resolved trades`	The quant tiles (ranges, SQN, Kelly, streaks) unlock at 8.
`No R basis`	No trade in view has a stop, Risk $ or R override. Add one.
`n excluded for having no Risk $ or stop (or an R past ±1000)`	Those trades have no measurable R. An R beyond ±1000 is treated as a typo (an extra zero in Risk $, or a stop almost on the entry) and left out of every R statistic. Fix the trade to bring it back.
`Replace cancelled: a copy of your current journal could not be saved first`	Nothing was changed. Check that the data folder (or the browser's downloads) can be written to, then try again.
`Too few trades to judge. Aim for 100+.`	Validate won't call an edge real under 30 trades.
`Multiple looks`	You've tested several Leave-out subsets; ranges are widened for it.
`Pooled accounts / mirrored`	Same signal in several accounts. Pick one account as Edge source.
`No proven edge. Check Validate first.`	Decision: expectancy ≤ 0, so the fee funds the firm, not you.
`Pass odds too low to budget`	Decision budget can't be bounded. Fix the edge first.
`too thin to size`	The Funded suggestions are withheld under 30 trades.
`checking against your edge's range…`	The Funded suggestions or the eval size (Decision) are being tested against plausible versions of your edge. It takes a few seconds.

`none pays back`	Funded: no size returns its fees in 9 of 10 plausible versions of your edge. The edge has to change, not the size.
`Most income sits at the top of the sizes tested`	The edge pays more the bigger it is sized. The real limits (firm size rules, slippage, account caps) are outside the model. Best ROI and Balanced keep your survival target.
`none keeps 85% / no Balanced or Best ROI row`	No size keeps your survival target over the account life in 9 of 10 plausible versions of your edge. Lower the target or the max account life, or log more trades to narrow the range.
`Pick a single account to use.`	Rule guard needs one account in scope, not All accounts.
`No dollar basis`	Rule guard: every rule is in dollars. Set what 1R is worth in Equity.
`n of m trades are not in these meters`	Some trades have no P&L, Risk $ or R value, so the meters are **optimistic**. Set what 1R is worth.
`No trades since funding`	Account marked funded but nothing logged since. Log a trade or switch back to eval.
`Day guard`	Losing streak or tilt logged today. Stop for the day.
`Not applied — only n trades left`	Leave-out would leave under 30 trades. The full record is still used.
`Too few trades to test timing`	Timing test needs 30+ trades on an axis, 2+ buckets of 4+.
`Nothing to sweep yet`	Add a Planned R:R to your trades.
`The planned R:R does not match…`	Most winners paid less than their planned R:R. The field probably holds MFE; replace it.
`Not enough logged runs to sweep on`	Log Full run (R) on 20+ winners. Without runs, the curve would just peak at the target you already use.
`Runs logged on only n% of winners`	Logging runs mainly on big winners biases the sweep toward bigger targets.
`Mixed targets — read the hits column`	Trades aimed at different targets; lower rows use fewer trades.
`n of m trades have no date / exit time`	Those trades are missing from that Timing table.
`Rules checked n days ago`	Firm presets may be out of date. Verify on the firm's site.
`No date column found / No result column found`	CSV import: rename a column to **Date**, and one to **R** (or **P&L** plus **Risk**).
`The dates in this CSV could be read either way`	Every date has a day of 12 or under. Pick Day / Month or Month / Day.
`n rows skipped`	CSV rows with no readable date or no result were left out.
`n rows have P&L but no R or Risk $`	Set what 1R is worth for that account (Equity) so they count.

24. What the model assumes

- **Your record is a fair sample of your future trading.** A record can't check this about itself.

- **Trades are drawn independently** in Challenge, Funded and Decision: no tilt, no streaks, no sizing up after a loss. (Validate's drawdown uses block resampling to keep clusters.)
- **The firm's published rules hold** as entered. Min days and consistency are modelled approximately.
- **Withdrawal habit**: up to 5% of the account every 5 trading days, never out of the drawdown cushion (section 21).
- **Not modelled:** payout cadence after the first payout, the risk of a firm not paying (collapse, rule changes, denied withdrawals), time value of money, taxes.
- **Why ranges, not single numbers:** every figure from your journal is re-run on resamples of your own record, so it shows the edge you might have, not just the one you measured. A range that crosses a line (zero, 85% survival) means the record can't yet say which side you're on.

Nothing in Edge Lab is financial advice, an endorsement or an affiliate link.

25. Glossary

`R`	What you planned to lose on one trade. All results are multiples of it.
`Resolved / decided / scratch`	Resolved = finished. Decided = a win or a loss. Scratch = closed at 0R, neither.
`Win rate`	Share of decided trades that won. On its own it decides nothing: 35% pays well if winners are 3× losers.
`Expectancy`	What one average trade is worth, in R. +0.20R = every trade adds a fifth of one risk unit on average.
`Reward : risk`	Average winner ÷ average loser. With win rate, it is the edge.
`Profit factor`	Gross wins ÷ gross losses. Under 1 you pay to trade; 1.25–1.5 is workable; over 3 usually means a small sample or one big winner.
`Total R / Total P&L`	Everything added up, in R or money.
`Balance`	Starting balance plus every priced trade in the **account**, whatever the filter.
`SQN`	System Quality Number (Van Tharp): expectancy ÷ its volatility, scaled by sample size; graded at n = 100.
`σ per trade`	Spread of R outcomes. Higher = bumpier ride and deeper holes for the same expectancy.
`Deepest drawdown so far`	The worst peak-to-trough fall this record has taken. One realisation, not a floor; Validate gives the forward distribution.
`Streaks`	Longest win and loss runs. Size for the loss run.
`Kelly f*`	The growth-maximising bet fraction, shown as the range your win-rate interval implies. Prop traders use a fraction of the lower end.
`Recent form`	Average R over the last 20 trades against the whole record.
`Best-day share`	How much profit came from one day, measured over windows the size of one evaluation target, the way firms measure it.
`Tail ratio`	Worst single loss ÷ average loss. Above 2 = a stop didn't hold or got moved.
`MFE / MAE`	Maximum favourable / adverse excursion: how far a trade ran for and against you while open.

`Full run`	How far price got before it would have hit your stop, whether or not you were still in.
`Exit efficiency`	Realised R ÷ MFE.
`p50 / p90 / p95 / p99`	Percentiles: the value that 50 / 90 / 95 / 99 runs in 100 stay within.
`CI / band / range`	The spread of plausible values given your sample.
`Effective sample`	How many independent observations your trades amount to after clustering.
`Noise floor`	How big a gap you get for free by picking the best of many buckets on a record with no real effect.
`Flat top`	Sizes or targets that pay within 3% of the best.
`Static / trailing / EOD`	Drawdown floor types; see section 18.
`Pass → paid`	One purchase all the way to money out.

26. Keyboard shortcuts

`Ctrl+N`	New trade (Journal).
`Ctrl+Enter`	Save the open trade.
`Ctrl+V`	Paste a screenshot into the open trade.
`← / →`	Previous / next trade in the detail view; previous / next image in the zoom view.
`+ / − / 0`	Zoom in / out / fit in the image view.
`Esc`	Close the open dialog.
`F5 / Ctrl+R`	Reload the app.

On a Mac, use `Cmd` instead of `Ctrl`.

27. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
`R stats are empty`	Trades need a stop, Risk $ or R override.
`No dollars anywhere`	Pick one account, **`Show dollars`**, set starting balance and what 1R is worth.
`Use my journal won't turn on`	Needs 10 resolved trades with an R basis in the Edge source.
`No Challenge / Funded / Decision tabs, no Rule guard`	Prop firm mode is off. Tick **`Prop firm`** in the Your account panel.
`Rule guard shows nothing`	Pick one account (not All accounts) and click Bind sim firm.
`Timing columns blank`	Log exit times (holding time), planned R:R (RR/kept), MFE (ran to).
`Numbers jump slightly on each change`	Monte Carlo noise. Quick previews run while you drag; full numbers land a moment after you stop.
`The ? button says the manual isn't installed`	Reinstall the latest build. In the browser version, keep this PDF in the same folder as the HTML file.
`"Windows protected your PC"`	The installer is free and not code-signed. Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. You never need to turn off Microsoft Defender or any antivirus.

`"Smart App Control blocked an app"`	Some new Windows 11 PCs block every unsigned app, with no Run anyway. Do not turn Smart App Control off (it cannot be turned back on without reinstalling Windows). Use the browser version instead: `Edge-Lab-browser.zip` from the releases page, unzipped, then open `Edge Lab.html`.
`macOS: "cannot be opened"`	macOS 14 and earlier: right-click the app → **Open** → **Open**. macOS 15 and later: open it once, then System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**. If it says the app "is damaged", run `xattr -cr "/Applications/Edge Lab.app"` in Terminal once.
`"Your journal is still in … PropEdgeLab"`	Since 2.18.6 the data folder is called `Edge Lab`, and the app renames the old `PropEdgeLab` folder on its first start. The message means a file in it was open in another program (often OneDrive syncing). Nothing is lost and the app works from the old folder; close the other program and restart Edge Lab to finish the rename.
`Journal missing after reinstall`	The data lives in `Documents\Edge Lab\`, not in the app. Check that folder, or Import your latest backup from `exports\`.